

The late Robert Kirby of Capital, the Los Angeles-based American investment giant, came up with the idea of the Coffee Can Portfolio in a short note he wrote over thirty years ago.² As is evident from the title, the Coffee Can Portfolio is at the heart of this book. More practically, both for Ambit's clients and for ourselves, the Coffee Can Portfolio has proved to be a life-changing investing construct. We owe a huge intellectual debt to Robert and wish he was around to read this book.

Many people are able to come up with ideas that can form the kernel of a good book. However, most people (including us till a few years ago) do not have the resources to turn those ideas into a book that can reach millions of people. Were it not for the research support provided at Ambit Capital by Divesh Mehta, Sudeep Pai, Kislay Upadhyay, Karan Khanna and Prashant Mittal, we would not have been able to write *Coffee Can Investing*. We are indebted to these gentlemen for the many months of effort, including public holidays and vacations, which they invested in this book.

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Jestin George, our editor at Ambit Capital, spent countless hours tidying up our grammatically incorrect writing. Sharoz Hussain, Ambit's formatting guru, turned our rough sketches into charts which are more powerful than most of our text. Sudhanshu Nahta at Ambit Capital worked tirelessly to pull the chapters and the hundreds of charts into a coherent narrative. Without these gentlemen, the book would not flow as nicely as it does.

To build and manage an Indian firm that attracts and retains the best talent in the country is not easy. To then give that talent downtime for intellectual adventures such as this is unheard of in India—nobody else does it in the country. Hence, we thank Ambit's CEO and co-CEO, Ashok Wadhwa and Rahul Gupta respectively, for giving us not just a job but an opportunity to do something bigger.